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There is a large community of developers for applications that run on eyeOS at www.eyeos-apps.org/

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# My eyeOS

## Have your head in the clouds? It's time to move our operating systems there

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### My OS

A few decades ago, people would have to book time on the computer in their organisation or university and await their turn. Today, most people have their own dedicated computers, so much so that we can choose to donate our free computational time for use in projects such as Seti@Home or Folding@Home.

In today's world, the computer has evolved from its geeky roots as a computational device, to one which is responsible for a considerable part of our entertainment and social interaction. It has become much more personal.

Thanks to your operating system, the complexities of millions of mathematical calculations to bring you each and every pixel you see on your screen are neatly abstracted away from you. All you see are objects on screen that you can relate to better than blobs of binary information. Operating systems too, have evolved to better suit to our personal needs. As our sphere of interaction with the computer, we tend to treat it much like we do our room or house. We put up our own wallpaper, install applications of our choice, customise the settings in order to have them suit our needs better.

Yet we also live in a mobile world, where we need to be connected to *our* information *our* way anywhere we go. We do everything to take our experience with us. We can use laptops / netbooks or other portable computers to physically take our computing environment with us, or we can merely take our operating environment, by installing it on a portable device such as a USB drive. Another option that we can have now, is keep our operating environment in the clouds, thanks to software such as eyeOS.

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### Cloud OS

There is a plethora of online applications to perform the tasks that you need. In fact, alternatives for most offline tools are available online. If you can access a web browser, it's quite easy to perform all your tasks online.

In our operating system, we organise our data in our own special manner. When we work online, we begin to lose certain privileges. We first need to download our data from our storage service to the computer, then upload it to the service capable of handling files of that nature, and after modifying it we need to download the modified file again, and upload it back to our storage.

Although many online services are now integrated, it is no match for the level of integration and choice we are accustomed to while working on our own desktops. Wouldn't it be much better if our entire OS was online?

Cloud OSs are the answer to this need. By keeping your data and your application on the server side, they move your entire application sphere online. You can now have the same benefits of personalisation and integration that we see in our desktop OS online.

### Introducing eyeOS

There are a number of online operating systems available today, and the number is steadily growing. eyeOS is one of the few that is not only provided for free as a service complete with online storage, but is also open source under AGPL3, so you can install it on your own server.

eyeOS is built on PHP and uses a combination of web standard technologies such as HTML, JavaScript and CSS to create the UI. This means that it will run on any standards-compliant browser. By itself, it doesn't require any extra plugins in order to work. All it needs is a PHP 5 capable server, which is the common denominator for just about any hosting package – it doesn't even require a database.

### Installing eyeOS

You can run eyeOS on your own computer using Apache with the PHP plugin. The best way is to just install AMP (Apache, MySQL, PHP) solution such as WampServer or XAMP, (although eyeOS does not require a database server).

You can begin by installing an AMP stack on your computer. While we'll consider WampServer as an example, the installation procedure is similar for most AMP packages.

After WampServer is installed, you can start it from the program menu. Since MySQL won't be used, it can be turned off to save resources.

The eyeOS installation package is a ZIP file, which will need to be extracted to a directory under the server root. In the case of WampServer, it is the www directory in the installation folder (by default "C:\wamp\www\"). This folder is where the files that will be served by Apache need to be stored. If you wish to install other applications on the same server, you will be better off installing eyeOS in its own directory (here, we've chosen the default eyeOS directory).

You can now start the installation procedure by entering **http://localhost/eyeOS/installer/** in your browser. It's a single step installation and it only asks for a root password and a hostname. You can also enable users to create their own accounts.